LATTICE · FIX DECK

Which class actually reaches the slide?

Three spellings write to one slot, and they are scoped differently. Forty of 168 combinations of `color-mode:` × `class:` × `_class:` rendered a canvas the author did not ask for. Every one was a deck that set two of them.

The register is filtered where it is read, not stripped afterwards.

A token the deck-wide `class:` may not carry never reaches a section at all, so every propagation kernel downstream is purely additive. The alternative — stamp it, then subtract — needs to know whether a token came from the deck or the slide, and by then that is gone.

The three spellings of `class:` are not interchangeable.

SPELLING	SCOPE	A SLIDE'S OWN `_class:`	MAY NAME A COMPONENT
`class:` **in front matter**	the whole deck	composes — appended over	no
`<!-- class: … -->`	here to the next one	replaces it	yes
`<!-- _class: … -->`	this slide	—	yes

Front matter is appended to every slide, including one naming its own layout — which is what makes `class: no-note` useful, and why a component there would collide rather than compose.

THIS DECK IS DARK

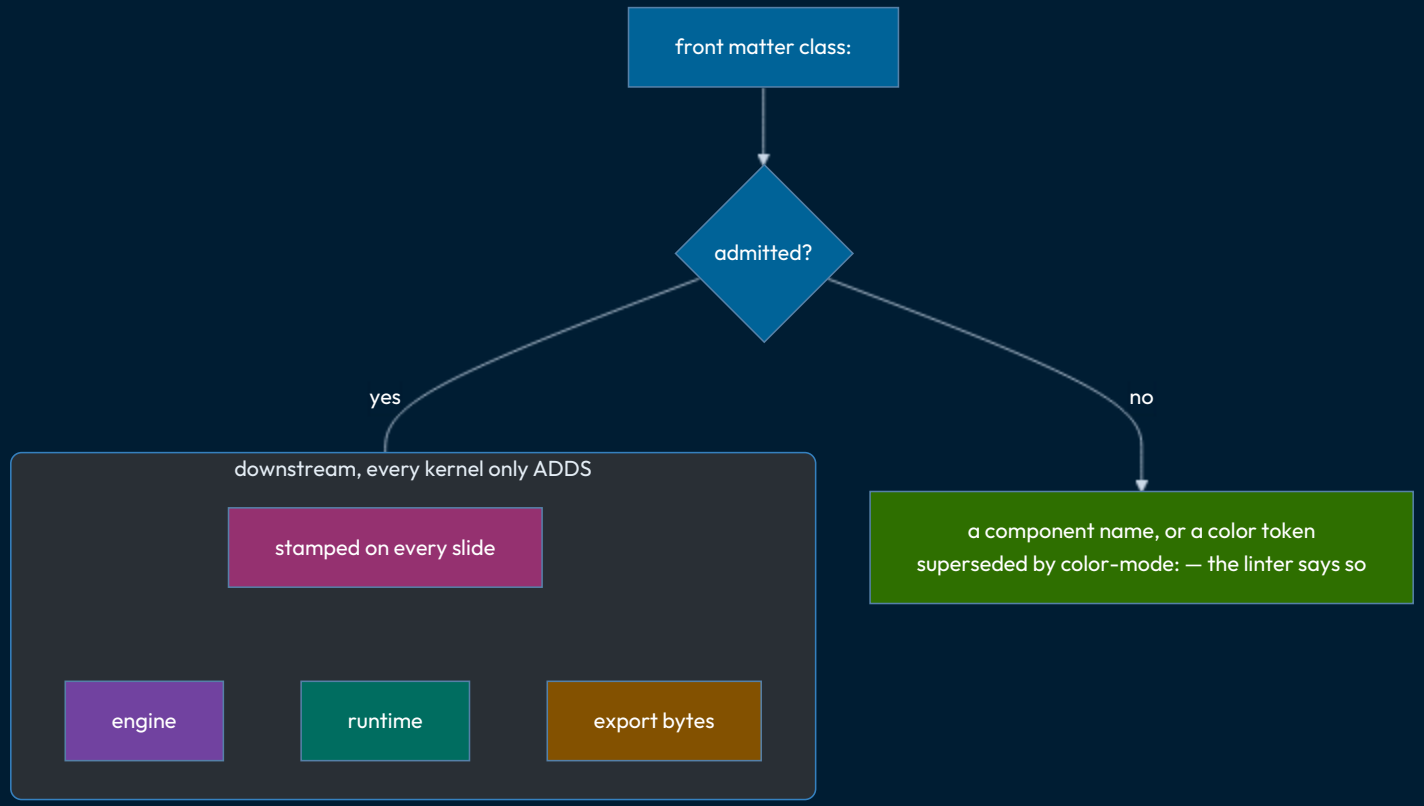
And this slide is not, because it said so.

The deck-wide color mode is `dark`; this slide names `light` for itself and wins. That is the one thing the supremacy rule deliberately does not touch.

What changed is only which DECK-WIDE register owns the axis when two claim it: `color-mode:` always does, and a leftover `class: dark` beside it is dropped rather than merged.

FILTERED AT THE BOUNDARY

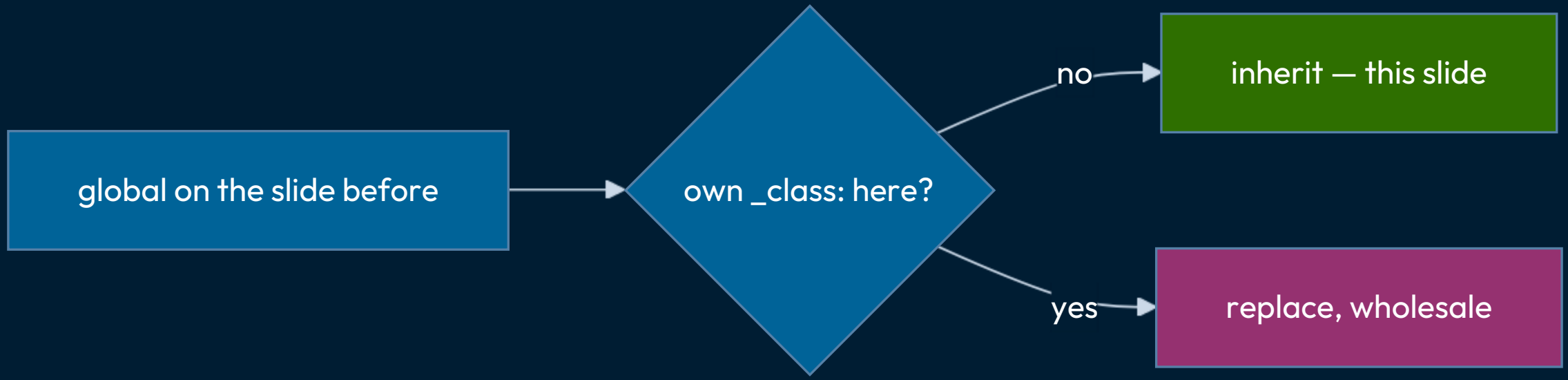
An illegal token is never stamped, so nothing has to be un-stamped.



NO DIRECTIVE ON THIS SLIDE

This slide is a diagram because the one before it said so.

`<!-- class: … -->` may name a component: a slide's own `_class:` replaces it wholesale, so it can never leave two layouts on one section.



THE REFUSAL IS NOT SILENT

A refused token is a warning, not a shrug.

```
⚠ deck · deck-wide-component [kpi]
    `class: kpi` names a COMPONENT deck-wide — every slide would be a kpi
    slide. It is ignored.
    fix: Name the layout per slide with `<!-- _class: kpi -->`, or once for a
         run with `<!-- class: kpi -->`.
```

See also.

`engineering/decisions/2026-08-05-deck-class-register-boundary.md` — the decision, the four regressions it avoids, and the 980-row table

`lib/core/deck-class-register.js` — the kernel, and every boundary it is applied at

`test/unit/core/color-register-table.test.js` — `color-mode:` × `class:` × `_class:` × `--print`, both spellings

`lib/base/base.docs.md` § Composition syntax — the three spellings, for authors